

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's take an acting class!



Learning Outcome

Describe situations in spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think an acting class might be valuable to people other than actors? How?
- Would you consider taking an acting class? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about work and entertainment.
- I can talk about emotions and reactions in different situations.
- I can make and respond to suggestions.





Let's Explore!

Emma Watson* did improvisations with the cast when she was on Broadway!

* "Emma Watson" is a famous actress. She is best known for playing Hermione in Harry Potter.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

If an actor finds one thing difficult, it's getting a job. Traditionally, this has happened through an audition. An audition has given a director the chance to see what the actor can do. Perhaps the actor prepared a monologue or speech from a play and presented this to the director. Maybe the director has given the actor a scene from the play that he or she wanted to cast.

The actor could also do a cold reading. In a cold reading the director has handed the actor an unfamiliar scene. When they really want to see someone that's their way to do it. If you're wonderful, it's the way to land the part. When you're not, it's try again later.

Sometimes, a director is putting together a company. If the actors work together, they become an ensemble. When that's the case, the director often asks the actors to do improvisations.

When an improvisation starts, and the actors have gotten into character, the director might suggest things like: "Don't you think you should reverse roles?" "You wouldn't really want to forgive her, would you?" "Couldn't you do it again and make different choices?" The actors then have to decide for themselves: "Sure I can", or "No, I wouldn't", or "Yes, I think I could."

Many actors have learned this way. Emma Watson did improvisations with the cast when she was on Broadway. It helped her understand that she was part of a solid unit that knew each other well. It has, she says, made all the difference to how she feels on stage.



**Let's Practice!**

Let's talk about work and entertaining.

Instructions: Read and circle the correct words to complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | | | | |
|------------------------------------|--|--|---|---|
| 1
scene
actor
cast | 2
Performing
Acting
Cold reading | 3
To direct
To cast
To act | 4
Direction
Improvisation
Performance | 5
To get into character
To cold read
To improvise |
|------------------------------------|--|--|---|---|

1. A _____ is a part of a play or film in which the action stays in one place for a continuous period of time.
2. _____ means to read an unfamiliar line, monologue or part of a text for the first time without any practice.
3. _____ is to choose actors to play particular parts in a play, film, or show.
4. _____ is a performance that an actor, musician, etc. has not practised or planned.
5. _____ is when an actor gets into the role of the person they are portraying.

**Let's Practice!**

Being in an audition is the ultimate task for an actor.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Select the incorrect word. Write the correct word to complete the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Traditionally, this has been through an audition.

2. An audition has opened a director the chance to see what the actor can do.

3. Perhaps the actress brought a monologue or speech from a play and offered this to the director.

4. Maybe the director gave the actor a scene from the play that he or she decided to cast.





Extension Activity

Prepare and present a short monologue.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find a short monologue from a modern English play online or at the library.
- Make a copy of the monologue and highlight words and phrases that are difficult, then look them up.
- Underline words you think should be stressed.
- Practice saying the monologue aloud.
- Present it to a partner or a group.
- Explain the background of the monologue. Who is the character? What is the situation?

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I find a short English monologue.

☐ ☐

I look up new words.

☐ ☐

I practice saying the monologue aloud, stressing important words.

☐ ☐

I present the monologue to a partner or a group.

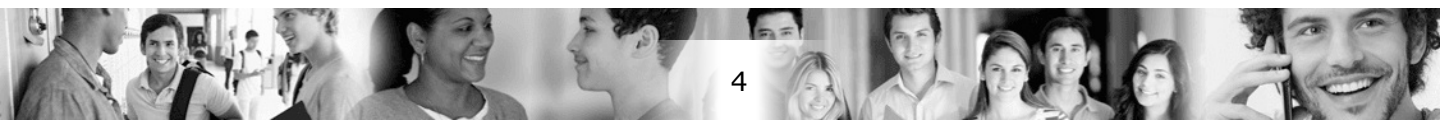
☐ ☐

I explain the background of the monologue.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- traditionally** (adverb): according to tradition; in a traditional way
e.g. Traditionally, this has happened through an audition.
- monologue** (noun): a long speech by one person
e.g. Perhaps the actor prepared a monologue or speech from a play.
- to present** (verb): to give, provide, or make something known
e.g. The actor presented his monologue to the director.
- scene** (noun): a part of a play or film in which the action stays in one place for a period of time
e.g. The director has handed the actor an unfamiliar scene.
- cold reading** (noun): reading an unfamiliar line, monologue or part of a text without any practice
e.g. The actor could also do a cold reading.
- to cast** (verb): to choose actors to play particular parts in a play, film, or show
e.g. Maybe the director has given the actor a scene from the play that he or she wanted to cast.
- unfamiliar** (adjective): not having any knowledge or experience of something
e.g. The director handed the actor an unfamiliar scene to read.
- to land (a part)** (verb): to be successful in getting the part you tried out for
e.g. If you're wonderful, it's the way to land the part.
- improvisation** (noun): a performance that an actor, musician, etc. has not practiced or planned
e.g. Emma Watson did improvisation with the cast when she was on Broadway.
- to get into character** (expression): when an actor puts themselves into the role of the person they are portraying
e.g. All the actors have gotten into character.





Learning Points

Making and Responding to Suggestions

You can use **modals** or the **zero conditional** to make suggestions.

Common phrases with **modals** you use to make suggestions are:

Do you think you should ...?

You could ...

You should ...

Couldn't you ...?

You can also use the **zero conditional** to make suggestions in a more indirect way.

For example:

If you're wonderful, it's the way to land the part.

The structure of the **zero conditional** is:

If + **Simple Present**, **Simple Present**

Examples:

- *Don't you think you should reverse roles?*
- *Couldn't you do it again and make different choices?*
- *If you're wonderful, it's the way to land the part.*
- *When you're not, it's try again later.*





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the **Simple Past tense** to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

You can use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about experience.

When you use the **Present Perfect tense**, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

I have learned English. = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.

He has bought a painting. = He bought the painting in the past and now he has a painting.

Usually, when you use the **Simple Past tense**, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

Yesterday, I **went** to the store.

Emma Watson **did** improvisations with the cast **when** she was on Broadway.

It is clear when the action occurred. In this sentence we would not use the **Present Perfect** (~~Yesterday, I have been to the store~~).

Examples:

- *The audition has given the director the chance to see what the actor can do.*
- *Perhaps the actor has prepared a monologue or speech from a play and presented this to the director.*
- *Maybe the director has given the actor a scene from the play that he or she wanted to cast.*
- *The director has handed the actor an unfamiliar scene.*
- *The actors have gotten into character, so the director may call out suggestions.*
- *Many actors have learned this way.*
- *Emma Watson did improvisations with the cast when she was on Broadway.*
- *It helped her understand that she was part of a solid unit that knew each other well.*

